

Literary Analysis Essay Rubric

	Sizzling A A-	Pretty Toasty B+ B B-	Lukewarm C+ C C-	Cold Fish D+ D
Analysis	Shows thorough, insightful, and highly perceptive understanding of the text's big ideas, characters, conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Delivers insightful, well supported analysis and crafts argument seamlessly. creative/original ideas and insights extensive commentary that goes beyond the obvious essay creates new thinking and understanding of text, uses academic language	Shows through and complete understanding of the text's big ideas, characters, conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Explains quotes and illustrates complex connection between quotes and thesis Spends most of the paper analyzing literary devices and developing ideas in a well-crafted, well-supported argument.	Shows some understanding of the text's big ideas, character's conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Paper moves past summary into analysis Understanding of the text is evident Analysis supports your argument, but ideas are obvious and basic	Shows little to no understanding of the text Does not construct a complex argument Analysis is unclear Ideas lack development or show a misunderstanding of prompt or text May present an illogical argument or analysis does not support thesis Only a summary is present
Thesis	Constructs a highly original, probing, insightful thesis and argument that illuminates something new about the text. Incorporates TAG(Title-Author-Genre) Seamlessly	Constructs a strong complex thesis and argument that goes beneath the surface but does not probe as deeply Includes TAG	Constructs a simplistic thesis and argument that may state the obvious. May be missing one or more element of TAG	Does not construct a complex thesis argument No mention of TAG
Textual Evidence	Selects highly insightful, persuasive evidence that clearly supports the claim Gives succinct, clear context for the quote Analyzes evidence insightfully and clearly explains its significance as it relates to claim Integrates evidence smoothly into overall commentary Cites evidence using correct MLA formatting	Selects strong evidence that clearly supports the claim Gives, clear context for the quote Analyzes evidence clearly and explains its significance as it relates to claim Integrates evidence smoothly into overall commentary Cites evidence using somewhat correct MLA formatting	Selects adequate evidence that supports the claim Gives some context for the quote, may provide context after quote Analyzes evidence on a superficial level and may lack connections to thesis and/or topic sentences Integrates evidence into overall commentary somewhat forcefully May be some errors in MLA formatting of quotes	Does not select evidence that supports the claim Does not give context for the quote Does not analyze evidence, may summarize each quote instead Makes little attempt at MLA formatting of quotes and citations
Introduction and Conclusion	Essay has an effective introduction that captures the interest of the reader, shows why the topic is relevant, and gives the information needed to understand the thesis. The conclusion restates the writer's argument successfully and makes a compelling appeal to the reader.	Essay has a clear introduction that gives the information needed to understand the thesis. The conclusion summarizes the writer's argument but may not add anything compelling to that argument.	Essay has an introduction, but it does not capture the reader's attention and/or does not give enough information for the reader to understand the thesis. The conclusion gives an incomplete restatement of the writer's argument.	Essay has only a minimal introduction and/or conclusion.
Paragraph Focus and Organization	Each body paragraph in the essay has a topic sentence that states a central idea and clearly relates to the thesis of the essay.	Each body paragraph in the essay has a topic sentence that states a central argument, but it may not always be clear how that argument relates to the thesis of the essay.	Most body paragraphs have a topic sentence, but some of these may state a fact or example rather than an idea.	Body paragraphs do not each have a central argument and/or it is unclear how body paragraphs relate to the thesis of the essay.
Clarity	Writing consists of complete sentences, with no run-ons or fragments. Writing includes sophisticated sentence structure and academic language. Writing is free from grammar and spelling errors.	Writing may have one or two errors in sentence structure, grammar or spelling. Or the writing may use repetitive or unclear vocabulary. Writing includes academic language and varied sentence structure.	There are more than one or two errors in sentence structure, grammar or spelling, and/or the word choice in the writing lacks clarity. Writing does not use specific vocabulary and academic language.	Errors in sentence structure, grammar and spelling make the writing difficult to understand. Slang may be prevalent in the essay.

